



BUYERS' GUIDE

ESTYLE

Fast, Functional And Affordable TABLETS



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Tablets of all sizes and prices have flooded the market. Every company is trying to bring out a tablet that will be the next big thing, and in the process there are some competitively-priced tablets available with tons of features. But how do you really choose one? Well, here are some things to keep in mind when you go tablet hunting.

Display technology. Thin film transistor (TFT) technology is the most common display technology used in mobile phones, but it consumes a lot of power. In-plane switching (IPS) technology offers better display quality as compared to TFT, as well as much better viewing angles, and consumes less power while being more expensive.

Organic light emitting diode (OLED) is made by placing a series of organic thin films between two conductors, and has better colour reproduction, faster response times, wider viewing angles and usually higher brightness compared to TFT.

Active matrix organic light emitting diode (AMOLED) is a step ahead of OLED screens as AMOLED screens can control each pixel individually while maintaining the properties of an OLED panel. These do not need a separate backlight. AMOLED screens use a different sub-pixel arrangement that may reduce the image quality a bit. Samsung uses this term for the AMOLED panels that they develop.

Super-AMOLED screens are built with capacitive touch sensors on the display itself. A super-AMOLED display is much more responsive than an AMOLED one.

Screen size and resolution. One of the most important factors to keep in mind while buying a tablet is the size of its screen. Smaller screens make it difficult to read text comfortably, while extremely large screens mean that the tablet is large and not too convenient to carry around. The recommended screen size will depend on your usage. For example, you will need a much higher resolution display if you want to read on your tablet, and a slightly larger screen if you plan to watch movies on your tablet. However,

if you plan to make phone calls on the tablet, a large screen will be inconvenient.

Screen resolution is also important. A screen resolution higher than 1280x800 pixels like Samsung's Tab 4 and its wide extended graphics array (WXGA) display is recommended for a 17cm tablet. Pixel density measured in pixels per inch (ppi) is very important if you intend to do a lot of reading.

Battery life. This is probably one of the most important deciding factors while selecting a tablet. When you are on the go, a tablet with a short battery life can be very frustrating. Fortunately, there are many tablets available in the market with battery lives ranging from six hours to 18 hours. However, do keep in mind that if you are using your tablet for movies and games, the battery life will reduce considerably. Invest in a tablet with a good battery life so that you do not have to bother too much about charging it from time to time.

Camera. Tablets are perfect for taking quick photographs or making video calls. Ensure that the tablet has good front and rear camera quality. Try to get a tablet with a rear camera of 8MP or higher, and a front camera of 2MP or higher. A good front camera will really improve your video-calling experience.

Calling feature. If you are looking for a tablet with a calling feature, there are many options available. These are usually quite compact in size, to ensure that making a phone call is not too inconvenient. Most tablets have 3G, Wi-Fi and Bluetooth connectivity and some come with the option of dual SIM.

Touchscreen. Since a tablet is all about ease of use, having a touchscreen that is not very sensitive can be quite annoying. Look for a tablet with a sensitive touchscreen that has multi-point touch, which provides better response and accuracy, and makes it easy to zoom into images.

Tablets to check out

Here are a few affordable tablets under ₹ 15,000 that are currently available in the

A tablet with a projector

If you are the type that loves streaming movies, then there is a tablet meant just for you. Lenovo Yoga Tab 3 Pro comes with a pico projector that allows you to recreate the theatre experience at home! Priced at ₹ 39,990, it does not come under the budget category, but it is the only tablet to have such a feature. The projector can also come in handy for business presentations. It also has Dolby Atmos audio technology to ensure great sound quality.